

Special Emphasis on the Development of Minorities

- ❖ Maharashtra is the first State to have established a separate department for Minorities.
- ❖ Substantial provision of Rs.160 crores allocated for this in the current financial year (2008-09).
- ❖ About Rs. 8 crore loan distributed to 1000 beneficiaries under the *Direct Loan Scheme*.
- ❖ Scholarships granted to about 37,000 meritorious students from Minorities.
- ❖ Minorities' representation in Police Recruitment Selection Committee.



Special Budget to Schedule Castes and Schedule Tribes

- ❖ Financial provision for progress of Scheduled Castes and Tribals as per their population.
- ❖ Substantial provision of Rs. 2332 crore in current budget for implementation of *Social Justice Schemes*.
- ❖ More than 1000 Ashramshalas for education to tribal children, 336 hostels for more than 30,000 students.
- ❖ Hostels for backward class students to be constructed in each district.

Initiatives in Education

- ❖ 30 per cent expenditure of development works of the State earmarked for education.
- ❖ Provision made for the socially and economically backward students to avail of educational loans through a 'Single Window System'.
- ❖ The Government has decided to reimburse educational fees to economically backward students who are studying in private non-aided educational institutions.
- ❖ It has decided to distribute free bicycles to the students who are studying in Std. VIII and are below poverty line. Rs. 20,000 crores has been allocated for this purpose.
- ❖ *Post-Matric Scholarship Scheme* for higher education to economically weaker students.
- ❖ Compulsory education to all 6-15 years age group students.
- ❖ Free textbooks to all girls up to Std. VIII and all SC/ST students.
- ❖ Insurance security cover to 2 crore 42 lakh students.
- ❖ *Savitribai Phule Foster Parent Scheme* to curb girl students drop out from school.
- ❖ *Mahatma Phule Education Guarantee Scheme* for out of school children between 6-14 age group to bring them in education mainstream.

